

Unit 4

Text A

5 - 8 自然段

5 One human need considerably impacted by social media is social connection. No doubt, social connection is an essential part of being human and also a significant factor contributing to happiness and health. Thanks to social media, we are the most connected society ever in history. Worldwide, approximately 3.5 million emails are sent per second. Predictably, the younger you are, the more you text. Yet the rise of social media is problematic, for it goes along with an apparent decline in mental health. More people have reported symptoms of being depressed in recent years than in the 1980s. Today's teens, in particular, are more likely to have trouble sleeping and more likely to need a professional for their mental health problems.

6 Certainly, numerous other factors may be driving this trend, but preliminary research links depression with social media usage. A University of Houston study found that the more time college students spent posting and chatting online, the greater the chance they would experience mild depression. The researchers attributed this to something called social comparison. When we compare

7 It has also been discovered that spending too much time online is interfering with or even causing withdrawal from face-to-face encounters. That is troubling because we know that we can get physically and psychologically ill if cut off from human influence. We improve our emotional state largely through being out in society. Not getting the right kind of human contact and support at key developmental periods of childhood may lead to serious emotional and psychological problems.

8 Another basic need impacted by social media is the need for novelty. Our human brain is biologically prepared for novelty, which, in turn, has helped us survive disastrous environmental change. Unfortunately, this natural thirst can become obsessive in the information age, in which every post, text, email, and online photograph is an opportunity to experience something new. As with an ardent chocolate lover at a candy store, the many choices are too stimulating, even exhausting.

Unit 5

Text A

8-9 自然段

8 The Crooks, who blazed a trail in the field of English teaching in New China, contributed to the training of generation after generation of foreign language talent in the fields of foreign affairs, history, trade and finance, journalism, education, etc. They were all inspired by the Crooks' spirit of selfless devotion. In the early 1960s, when the Soviet Union withdrew all their experts from China, the Crooks chose to stay. They said, "China is faced with economic difficulties. At a crucial moment like this, we can't just leave." So, without hesitation, they turned down the job offer from the University of Leeds.

9 The life of the Crooks in China was both ordinary and extraordinary. It was ordinary because they were always in the grass roots – a member of the Shilidian work team and a faculty member at school. It was extraordinary because they left their homeland for the Chinese revolutionary cause, to which they made an absolute commitment. The friendship between the Crooks and the Chinese people is eternal! The Chinese people will never forget what David Crook said in the 1980s: "I am confident that by the end of this century … China, which Isabel and I love, which has become our second homeland, will be creating a strong socialist society."

Unit 6

Text A 11-14 自然多

11 Cliff came to prominence again in 1997, at the age of 75, when he attempted to become the oldest man to run around Australia and raise money for homeless children.

12 For the rest of his life, Cliff kept running. Over the years, **despite** increasing age and physical challenges, he participated in many races and won a few. It was said that Cliff Young had never kept a single prize. People gave him watches because he never had one. He would thank them because he did not want to hurt their feelings, but then would give them away. He said, "I don't need a watch. I know when it's daylight, when it's dark, and when I'm hungry."

13 His love for running never **dimmed**, but in the year 2000, he suffered a mild **stroke** that ended his heroic running days. Cliff Young, the running **legend**, passed away on November 2, 2003. He was 81.

14 To this day, Cliff Young remains a **magnificent** reminder and **brilliant** example of how ordinary **individuals** can achieve remarkable results. As the famous saying goes, "Where there's a will, there's a way!" With determination and preparation, we can achieve distinction and be a brilliant example to others.